of universal equality was not predicated on the absence of ethnic or religious particularity.

While it is true that throughout the nineteenth century, a powerful trend of opinion demanded of the Jews that they assimilate (or regenerate, in the language of the day), it is also true that an equally strong current was far more sanguine about Jewish difference. Before the outbreak of racist, nationalist antisemitism in the 1880s, Jewish composers like Meyerbeer and Halevy, Jewish jurists like Adolphe Crémieux, and Jewish actresses like Rachel Félix staked out positions in the French public sphere while boldly and publically proclaiming their Jewishness. Their Jewishness was not seen as a liability, as an obstacle to Frenchness, or as something to be glossed over or swept under the rug. Indeed, the two identities—Jewish and French—were seen to go hand in hand. Even during the French Revolution, when the model of French republican universalism first emerged, its theorists did not all demand the suppression of Jewish particularity. Read closely, the speeches of certain of the revolutionaries who debated Jewish emancipation did welcome Jewish difference precisely as a means of proving the reach of French universalism. Indeed, the terms by which the Jews were emancipated in France make no mention of cultural or religious assimilation: as long as the Jews gave up their autonomous communal structures, they were free to assert their difference freely and openly, and many did precisely that.

My point is to suggest that the universal and the particular have not been always as opposed as Badiou and his supporters assume them to be. There have been ways of moving beyond the binary that allow for Jewish particularity to persist even within a French universalist context. Let me conclude with a reference to another leftist theorist, Jean-Claude Milner, a sparring partner of Badiou, who offers a compelling critique of the latter's hostility to Jewish particularity.[22] Milner suggests that we distinguish between what he calls the "easy universal" of Badiou, modeled on Saint Paul, supersessionism, and the repression of all forms of minority particularism, and a more "difficult universal," one derived from particularity which takes difference into account as the ground for a more inclusive form of universality. "Not only is the time ripe for the thinking through of the difficult universal," Milner tells us, "but the return of the name of the Jew obliges us to such a thinking through."[23]

NOTES

1. On the "new antisemitism," see Robert S. Wistrich, *A Lethal Obsession: Anti-Semitism from Antiquity to the Global Jihad* (New York: Random House, 2010), 33–34. Pierre-André Taguieff uses the term "Judeophobia" to designate hatred of

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